The GeForce4 Ti 4200 and Ti 4600 are nVidia's answer to the Radeon 8500. Although the 8500 retains a slight lead in the architecture department, consider the excellent driver support that nVidia provides and the fact that the Ti 4200 and Ti 4600 are designed with future games in mind and you have the winners among the big boys.

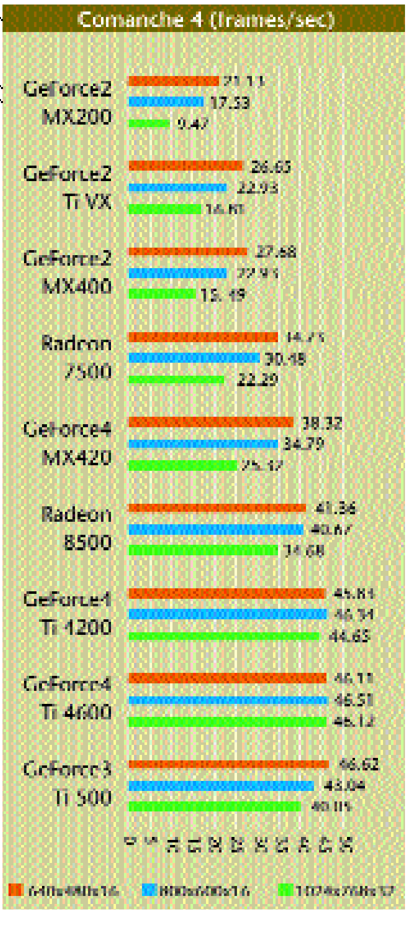
**Comanche 4 (Direct 3D)**

*Comanche 4* is a helicopter-based action game that demands a chipset with hardware T&L support in order to run. Our low-end solutions are thus shown the door as the ATi Rage 128 Pro, Radeon VE, Trident T64 and the TNT2 M64 walk out in shame.

At the highest resolution of 1024x768, the GeForce2 MX200 scores a pitiful 9.47 fps while the MX400 manages to squeeze out a mere 15.49 fps. Even at lower resolutions neither of these chipsets managed to cross the bare minimum score of 30 fps. The ATi Radeon 7500 and the GeForce4 MX420 also show a similar performance and fail to cross the 30 fps mark. Considering the fact that these chipsets should allow for higher resolution gaming, their performance in anything except the lowest setting reflects quite badly on them.

None of the chipsets in our test manage to cross our 60 fps boundary. Even the high-end GPUs are left licking their wounds at around 40-50 fps. An interesting fact to note is the difference in the scores that the GPUs registered under the three resolutions—the point of interest being that there is virtually no difference! The ATi 8500 maintains a score in the 35-40 fps range, regardless of resolution. Similarly, the GeForce3 and the GeForce4 chipsets hover around the 40-45 fps mark, neither rising nor falling significantly. (Another noteworthy point is that the GeForce3 Ti 500 chipset beats the GeForce4 Ti 4200 and Ti 4600 at lower resolutions.) The reason might be one of two things: the engine running *Comanche 4* is extremely CPU sensitive and will only scale with processor speed, not so much the graphics chipset speed. Or, the CPU in the test system is being a bottleneck and is not feeding

INFOGRAPHICS: Jaya Shetty

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